Rapid Needs Assessment: Flood Response in Kasoro District

Assessment dates: 6–9 October 2026 · Prepared by: Emergency Response Team, Northern Programme
Distribution: Country Director, Programme Quality Unit, Cluster Coordinators

1. Summary

Heavy rains between 28 September and 3 October caused the Kasoro River to overflow its banks in four sub-counties. An estimated 4,870 households were affected, of whom 1,215 are currently displaced in schools, churches and host families.

Key findings

- Shelter is the most urgent need: 62% of displaced households sleep in overcrowded classrooms.
- Seven of eleven boreholes in the flooded area are contaminated or inaccessible.
- Standing maize ready for harvest was lost on about 1,900 hectares.
- Two health centres remain functional but have run out of oral rehydration salts.

2. Context

Kasoro District lies in the lowland plain north of the regional capital and has a population of about 214,000. The district was last flooded in 2019, when the response was delayed by the collapse of the Mbale road bridge. This year the bridge held, and access by road remains possible except to two parishes of Ongora sub-county.

Table 1. Affected and displaced population by sub-county (local government figures, 8 October 2026)

Sub-county	Households affected	Households displaced	Persons displaced	Main sites
Ongora	1,640	512	2,560	Ongora Primary School, St. Jude Church
Kidera	1,385	341	1,705	Kidera Seed School
Abwoch	1,102	228	1,140	Host families
Lwala East	743	134	670	Lwala Trading Centre hall
Total	**4,870**	**1,215**	**6,075**	

3. Methodology

The team of six visited 14 displacement sites and 9 villages over four days. Data were collected through 38 key informant interviews, 12 focus group discussions and direct observation using a standard checklist. Household numbers were taken from local government registers and cross-checked at each site.

4. Findings

4.1 Shelter and non-food items

Displaced families occupy 31 classrooms, with an average of 14 households per room. Most families left with only clothing, and very few have sleeping mats, blankets or cooking sets.

4.2 Water, sanitation and hygiene

Table 2. WASH indicators at displacement sites compared with minimum standards

Indicator	Ongora	Kidera	Abwoch	Lwala East	Standard
Functional water points	1 of 4	2 of 3	1 of 2	0 of 2	1 per 250 persons
Litres per person per day	6	9	11	4	15
Persons per latrine	96	71	48	120	20
Handwashing stations	None	2	1	None	At every latrine block

Open defecation was observed around three of the larger sites, and two suspected cholera cases were reported at Ongora on 8 October. Water trucking by the district authorities covers only Kidera and is irregular.

4.3 Food security and livelihoods

The flood struck two weeks before the main maize and bean harvest. Household food stocks are expected to last less than three weeks for most displaced families. Market prices of maize flour in Kasoro town rose by 35% between 1 and 9 October.

4.4 Health and nutrition

Both Kidera and Abwoch health centres are open, but staff report a sharp rise in diarrhoea and malaria among children under five. Mid-upper arm circumference screening of 412 children found 23 cases of moderate and 4 of severe acute malnutrition.

5. Recommendations

1. Distribute emergency shelter kits and non-food items to all 1,215 displaced households within ten days.
    1. Prioritise Ongora and Kidera, where crowding is worst.
    2. Coordinate with the Red Cross to avoid double distribution.
2. Restore safe water at displacement sites.
    1. Chlorinate and disinfect the seven affected boreholes.
    2. Install emergency latrines and handwashing stations at the 14 sites.
3. Provide a one-month food ration or cash transfer to displaced households.
4. Supply both health centres with oral rehydration salts, zinc and malaria test kits.

Table 3. Indicative budget for the first response phase

Item	Unit cost (USD)	Quantity	Total (USD)
Shelter kit (tarpaulin, rope, tools)	38.00	1,215	46,170.00
Household NFI kit	27.50	1,215	33,412.50
Borehole rehabilitation	1,450.00	7	10,150.00
Emergency latrine block	620.00	40	24,800.00
Cash transfer, one month	45.00	1,215	54,675.00
Total			**169,207.50**

6. Next steps

The Programme Quality Unit will review this report on 14 October and submit a funding request to the emergency pooled fund. A follow-up assessment of Ongora is planned once the road to the two cut-off parishes reopens.